

NUMENÉRA™



FORGETTING DOOMSDAY

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FORGETTING DOOMSDAY

This adventure is designed to be played at a convention or other scenario with about a four-hour time slot. Thus, you'll notice sections about keeping track of time or hurrying things along. Feel free to ignore these and move at your own pace if you're playing without a time limit.

Two villages, Ovon and Zeph, sit at either end of a long valley, separated by a ravaged, war-torn stretch of land. Founded generations ago by twin brothers with the shared dream of an empire, they are now separated by a long history of hatred and war.

When an installation in the middle of the valley—created during the brothers' war so long ago—suddenly activates, spreading the age-old threat of a disastrous memory-eating virus, it's up to the player characters (PCs) to solve the mystery and save their loved ones before they forget what matters most.



Numenera Discovery



Numenera Destiny

This adventure includes page references to various subjects accompanied by these symbols. These references are to *Numenera Discovery* and *Numenera Destiny*, where you can find additional details about that item, place, creature, or concept. It isn't always necessary to look up the referenced items in the corebooks; doing so is a way to learn more about the Ninth World and provide additional information to your players.

INTRODUCTION

The player characters grew up in one of the two villages and work for the ruling official of that village. Like everyone else in their village, they know some amount of the history of the war between the brothers and the devastation that followed. It's possible that they harbor resentment, hatred, or mistrust toward the inhabitants of the other village. In order to save themselves and their village, they will have to overcome these hurdles, and quickly, so they can work with the others before time runs out.

On the day the adventure begins, an installation in the war-torn section of land activates, releasing a horrible forgetting "virus" that infects everyone in the valley, causing them to start losing their memories—not just of past experiences and loved ones, but basic survival memories, such as how to walk, eat, fight, and stay alive.

The characters from both towns are sent out by the town leaders to inspect the installation and, hopefully, stop the virus before too much harm is done. After learning what they can from the installations, the characters discover that they can create an "antidote"—basically, they can alter the installation in such a way that it will not only stop projecting the mental virus, but reverse the damage that's been done. The component they need is inside the brothers' old workshop, in an area of the world none of them have ventured before.

The pregenerated character sheets give backgrounds on the characters, including detailing which village each PC grew up in.

GAMEMASTER CONSIDERATIONS

This adventure has a few unique elements that are good for the GM to consider and prepare for ahead of time.

A Split Party. At the beginning of the adventure, the party is split into two groups, each of which will start in one of the two villages. GMing this type of opening isn't difficult, but it is different, and so there are tips in that section to help you.

An Intrusion. At a point in the adventure (noted in the text), the players will receive a transmission from someone outside the group. There is a link to an audio file in the text; you can download this onto your phone or computer and play it for your group. Alternatively, the written text of the transmission is included in the adventure, so that you can read it to the group, record it yourself, or ask someone outside the group to orate it at the table.

It is rumored that at the very end of their lives, the brothers reconciled and made peace, determined to bring their villages back together, but by then it was too late. Neither of them lived to see that happen.

Once the group joins forces and heads off, a strange thing occurs: they receive a transmission from someone already at the workshop. It likely won't take long for the PCs to realize that this isn't the first time the installation has activated, and that a different group has already been sent off to find the necessary component. (Note: None of the PCs remember this, at all.)

When the PCs arrive, they find Yigit, the remaining member of the original group, and discover a few different options for getting a new component. If they acquire the component, they can return home and repair the installation, essentially killing the virus and reversing the damage. Whether they go on to make peace or continue to fight their founders' war is up to them.

BACKGROUND

THE BROTHERS' WAR

Founded generations ago by two brothers, Ovon and Zeph, the villages that now bear their names lie at opposite ends of what was once a fertile valley. The brothers were inventors and dreamers, dedicated to working together to create amazing devices and installations that would better people's lives. Their goal was to spread the two villages inward across the valley, joining them into a thriving empire to be called OvonZeph. Or possibly ZephOvon.

And therein lies the rub: even as their villages grew and prospered, the two brothers began to fight. Over the name of their future empire. Over the types of devices and installations to focus on. Over whose ideas and inventions were better.

It wasn't long before strained communication became no communication. And then, as feuds between brothers are wont to do, the conflict grew deeper and darker. The brothers began to turn their plans for progress into plans for war—power-supplying installations became destructive devices, guard automatons found new life in the form of warriors, water filtration systems were altered to deliver poisons and disease.

It is impossible to know which brother threw the first proverbial stone. Or, in this case, blasted the first turret barrage across the valley. But it's easy to see the outcome of the brothers' long war: all along the valley between the villages, the earth is torn and blasted. Giant installations and automatons lay shattered, already grown over with vines



and claimed by wild creatures. The air stirs with dark particulates; the ground weeps orange and yellow tears.

Today the villages, too, bear the scars of the long war. Where once they were growing cities, stretching into the space between with people and plans, businesses and farms, now both have pulled back, put up walls, and closed up into themselves. Growth is considered risky, more likely to lead to death and destruction than anything good. Even the numenera—while understood to be vital—is sometimes treated with deep suspicion.

OVON

Ovon is a small village on the southern end of the valley. It has about 600 people, many of whom have an affinity for working with the numenera. This is evidenced by the large number of installations that protect the edges of the village, help produce clean food and water, and heal the sick. Ovon citizens tend to be insular—after all, where else would they go, other than the valley of devastation (which they call the Harrow) or the town of Zeph. The village leader, a woman named Lilija, sees a problem in the near future—they have food, water, and protection, but are growing short on the materials needed to build more installations and keep the present ones running.

ZEPH

Zeph is a small village on the northern end of the valley. It's larger in spread than Ovon, but has a few hundred fewer inhabitants. There is land for raising crops and animals, as well as for community gathering spaces. Zeph inhabitants call the valley between the towns the Agony Fields. The village leader, a man named Blas, has been trying to encourage exploration, but while a few have followed his suggestions, most have no desire to venture into that space.

BEGINNING THE SCENARIO

When the adventure begins, some of the characters are in Ovon and some are in Zeph. The six pregenerated characters are split evenly between the two villages. If you have fewer than six players, try to divide them as evenly as possible between the two villages. It's a normal morning, and the inhabitants of the city are going about their

GM TIP: This section is designed to let you alternate between villages (and thus between groups of characters). It is the “call to adventure” for the PCs. To make it interesting, the GM can play up the characters of the two leaders and the PC's interactions with them as they prepare to venture forth. The leaders' personalities are important to establish, as they will have been changed by the virus by time the characters return.

day. The player characters are at work—each of them plays a unique role at their leader's side—when the alarm sounds.

UNEXPECTED WARNING

Everyone in both villages hears a series of alarms blare at the same time. This “sound” is not actually audible—it's a telepathic transmission—but characters might not be able to discern the difference at first. The alarm is accompanied by a strong sense of unease, as if there was something important one was supposed to do, but has forgotten.

STARTING IN OVON

Characters starting in Ovon have just heard the alarm; Lilija has gathered them together. She says she believes that the signal is from one of the broken installations in the valley and would like them to accompany her to investigate. She has a vague memory of an old story about an installation powering up and doing something horrible, although she can't remember the details. Which is unusual for her. It's clear that she's uneasy about the whole matter.

She asks the PCs to gather anything that they need to get started and to meet her by the front gate.

Lilija: Lilija is tall and broad-shouldered, with a voice so quiet you have to lean in to hear her. (Most people agree it's an affectation, but it's an effective one.) She's been the leader of this village for six years and easily earns the respect and loyalty of the villagers. Both fierce and tender, she knows everyone by name, and tries to care for those in her villages as if they were family.



Lilija: level 5, level 6 for leadership, positive interaction skills, and history; carries a flail

STARTING IN ZEPH

Characters starting in Zeph have just heard the alarm; Blas has gathered them together. He tells them a story of a time that something similar happened—an installation sent out a warning, and then the city was attacked by a giant bird, or bat, or maybe a herd of flying automatons? He can't quite remember, but he knows that it was bad. If this is something similar, then it needs to be shut down before it can do any damage. And if it's not bad, then they should go get a good story out of it before it's too late!

He asks the PCs to gather anything that they need to get started and meet him by the front gate.

Blas: level 5, level 6 for strategic planning, leadership, and tracking; carries a buzzer

Blas: Blas has one metallic leg that gleams in the sun, and he carries a cane decorated with the beak from a broken hound. Most would agree he is eccentric and a bit garrulous, but he gets around to his point eventually. More importantly, he gives his heart and soul to his village, doing his best to lead it—and those who live there—into a better future.

THE HARROW / AGONY FIELDS

Once the characters are ready and have met their leader at the gate, they head into the area between the villages—known as the Harrow or the Agony Fields, depending on which village the characters hail from. Most of the characters have probably not ventured very far into the valley before; their leaders have gone farther than they have, but not by much. It doesn't take long before they are in an area none of them have visited.

The area outside the village walls is not as devastated as it once was. The air is no longer filled with particles and poisons, but it still smells and tastes slightly of rot and decay. Plants and mosses have dug in; creatures have made their homes in the destroyed remains of installations, weapons, and vehicles.

The going is not difficult, despite the littered terrain. There are mostly level trails—possibly made by creatures—that crisscross the expanse.



OVON VENTURES FORTH

Lilija has a small device that she uses to guide her to the installation from which she believes the warning signal came. She follows it steadily, leading the group. She has a bit of tolerance for people wanting to check things out as they pass—she understands that this is all new and interesting—but she urges everyone forward, reminding them of the alarm and the possibility of an attack.

ZEPH VENTURES FORTH

Blas seems to lead the group toward the installation mostly by instinct. He stops to sniff the wind, scan the ground, and watch the birds before moving them forward. As the group passes interesting things, he's likely to launch into a story of the war, sometimes getting so distracted that for a few moments, he seems to forget there's any time pressure at all. If someone reminds him he will say, "Oh, of course! The alarm!" and move everyone along—at least until the next interesting thing shows up.

THE INSTALLATION

It's only about an hour's walk from either village to reach the installation. Nothing eventful or dangerous happens on the way. However, the characters continue to feel like something's off—maybe a sense of mental unease or faint nausea. The virus affects everyone in slightly different ways.

Both groups arrive at the installation around the same time. This is what they see: three metallic spheres lay on the ground, with blue tubes running between them to form an askew triangle about 6 feet (2 m) on each side. The tubes are burbling, as though there is something liquid running inside them.

Within the triangle, a tall, metallic device rests, half-buried in the ground. The device is irregular and jagged in shape, although it's hard to tell how much of that is the original design and how much the ravages of time and war. It sticks up 5 feet (1.5 m) above the ground and leans sideways so far that the top reaches outside the triangle and rests only a foot or so above the ground. Through the metallic shell, it is possible to see blue lights moving around inside.

MEETING THE OTHERS

Despite everything going on with the installation, the townsfolk may consider each other the more interesting oddities. The leaders of the villages have never met, nor have the PCs met the PCs from the other villages. Depending on their personalities and backgrounds,, the PCs may treat those from the other town with curiosity, camaraderie, or even suspicion. Lilija and Blas are likely to be protective of their group and of their knowledge at first, but eventually will agree to work together for the good of their people.

They will guide the PCs into working together—whether agreeably or under duress—to tackle the next steps. Likely, they will ask some of the PCs to keep an eye out for danger while others inspect the installation.

INSPECTING THE INSTALLATION

Upon successful inspection, the PCs can discover the following.

- There is a stamp in the metal that was once used by the brothers to show they'd created a device together.
- This device was designed to keep everyone in the valley safe from mental effects.
- A piece of the device seems to have been damaged during the war, but started malfunctioning only recently, causing it to have the opposite effect—it unleashed one of the mental viruses it had once "captured" on everyone in the valley. The effect was instantaneous; everyone who was in the valley at the time of the activation is already infected.
- This particular virus seems designed to affect people's memories, slowly making people forget basic skills and life experiences.
- It seems likely that replacing the burnt-out component would reverse the effect, essentially re-capturing the mental virus and undoing the effects.
- Destroying the device doesn't stop the virus, as it's already in the world; in fact, it would mean having to repair it completely before being able to install the replacement component.

MIMETAN ATTACK

While some of the PCs are inspecting the installation, two mimetans slither in from the surrounding area and attempt to sneak attack one or more of the PCs.

GM intrusion

suggestion: As the PCs are inspecting the installation, one of the blue tubes running along the ground is cut open, breaks, or somehow becomes untethered, spewing an effervescent clear liquid onto the ground. The liquid smells like baking bread and almost seems to crawl toward organic matter. If it touches organic matter, it starts to sizzle and burn. PCs must make a difficulty 5 Speed defense roll to avoid taking 2 points of damage.

Installation: level 5

Memory virus: All

memory and recollection tasks are hindered for characters infected with the memory virus. After two days of infection, tasks are hindered by two steps. After four days, tasks are hindered by four steps. Those who spend more than a few hours within long distance of the installation are hindered by two additional steps.

MAKING A PLAN

Once the installation is inspected and the mimetans dealt with, Liliya tells the PCs about the brothers' workshop, a place where the two were rumored to have planned and built all of their early devices. If it still exists, it's located in a place called the Brymeck Morass, and is likely their best bet for finding a replacement component.

Blas knows of the area and will draw the group a rough map to the morass. He takes a small, thin device, called a Transmission Amulet, off of his belt and hands it to one of the members of the group, explaining how it works and instructing them to let the others know when they're on their way back. He might also tell a story about how he once had a cypher that could instantly move people from one place to another, wishing he still had it for the PCs to use and saying he can't recall what he did with it. (He gave it to Yigit before that group headed out, but doesn't remember doing so.)

The two leaders agree they will stay here to study the installation further to try and mitigate the virus as much as possible.

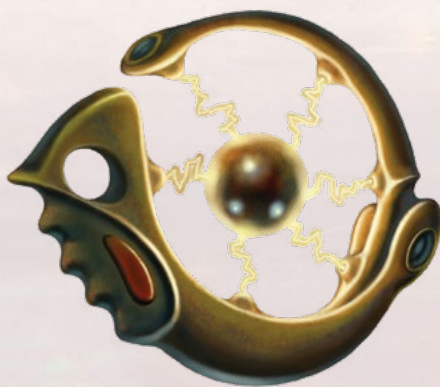
TRANSMISSION AMULET

Level: 5

Form: A plain metallic disk on a chain

Effect: Can be used to record and send a transmission to another transmission amulet up to a mile away. Can also be used to or hear a transmission sent from another transmission amulet up to a mile away (automatically receives any messages when in range).

Depletion: —



Spheres: level 3

Time Check: As the PCs head to the workshop, you're about halfway through the adventure. You should have around two hours left if you're running a four-hour game.

If you feel like the characters are rushing through things, have them encounter one or both of the creatures in the Morass. If the beginning took more time than you expected, you can skip the encounters and keep them moving toward the workshop.

TO THE WORKSHOP

The map is simply drawn but easy to follow, as is the path. It's not entirely easy going—it requires navigating around or over small pits or destroyed devices, but they're fairly simple obstacles to overcome. The path winds up the sloped side of the valley. From the top, the PCs can look down and see both towns and the valley between. They've never seen the desolation, or their homes, from this vantage before. The vast majority of the land is war-torn, with the villages themselves taking up small spots of space on either end.

GM Tip: Don't be afraid to let the PCs from opposite towns get to know each other as they travel. Establishing personalities, conflicts, and discoveries is a great way to set them up as a team (or not) for what comes next.

The trail continues across the flat, heavily wooded land. Soon, the ground begins to soften, growing squishy and muddy beneath the characters' feet. The smell of sulfur and the sounds of various amphibians and birds wrap around them. This is Brymeck Morass.

BRYMECK MORASS

Brymeck Morass is a swampland filled with trees, flowering plants, and a variety of brightly colored critters that swim, hop, and fly. The path continues, and unless characters step off of it, making their way through the swamp is mostly an easy endeavor.

Rising from the water here and there on either side of the path are translucent spheres about 3 feet (1 m) across. They bob

MIMETAN

2 (6)

These 1-foot (30 cm) long slugs composed of translucent goo have hardened and dangerous-looking ridges running along their edges. They can form mouths filled with ridge-like teeth.

These creatures are called by many names besides mimetan, including slither, night slider, and mimetic horror. They're accidents of ancient tech, birthed by a material component known as mimetic gel that mimicked a living thing. Now they "live" to eat and replicate themselves. However, they can also take on the semblance of other objects. Several mimetans can join together to create a realistic facade of objects much larger than an individual mimetan. Mimetans can't take on the appearance of objects or creatures that are not already present, which means sometimes mimetans can be detected by the mere fact that there are two of something where earlier there was only one. But which is the mimetan?

Motive: Hungers for flesh

Environment: Small groups of two or three that can quickly duplicate themselves into a large group if a food source is available

Health: 6

Damage Inflicted: 3 points

Movement: Immediate (or short when several take on the guise of a larger creature)

Modifications: Climbs as level 5. Disguise tasks as level 7. Speed defense as level 4 due to size.

Combat: A mimetan prefers to attack with surprise, taking on its true form to bite a target that wasn't previously aware that the tool they were holding is a hungry, shape-changing worm. Each time a mimetan successfully inflicts a full 3 points of damage, it replicates itself using the stolen flesh at the beginning of its next turn. Now two mimetans can attack, each one capable of duplicating itself again in the same way.

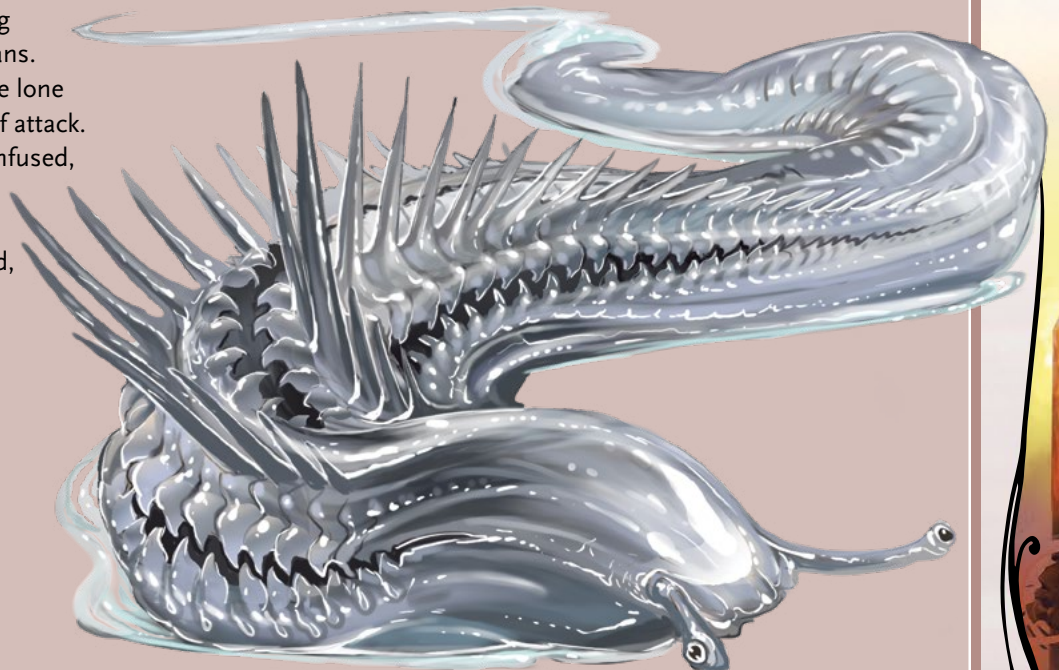
When four of these creatures attack as one, treat them as a single level 4 creature that inflicts 6 points of damage.

A successful group attack that does the full 6 points of damage produces two additional mimetans.

A group of ten or more mimetans may attempt to hold a victim immobile. If a victim can be held immobile for two consecutive rounds, the group of mimetans may duplicate the victim in guise, in bearing, and to a very limited extent, in mind.

Interaction: Mimetans can't communicate unless ten or more have taken on the guise of a creature that can communicate. Even then, the faux creature is confused, partly inarticulate, and likely to reveal its true nature soon enough, collapsing into a swarm of mimetans.

Use: The characters find the lone survivor of some kind of attack. The survivor is hurt, confused, and partly inarticulate. They can't seem to describe what happened, but they ask for shelter and food.





Baasog: level 4, do 3 points of damage with their long, serrated tongues

Abykos: level 4, defends as level 5; health 12, inflicts 4 points of damage with its long, seemingly metallic claws

As an attack, an abykos can touch an object that uses transdimensional energies, such as an artifact or a cypher. Instead of taking damage, the object is drained of power and becomes useless. The abykos gains +5 health when it does this, even if the increase puts it above its maximum health.



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up and down, sometimes sinking fully below the surface, other times rising up to rest as much as a foot above it. The spheres have one or more holes in the sides, through which it's possible to see small, moving shapes. The spheres are made of strongglass. Nested inside some of them are frog-like amphibians called baasogs.

Baasogs: Baasogs are about a foot wide, stand on two legs that end in giant webbed feet, and can fly short distances. Their tongues, which can extend up to 3 feet (1 m) are serrated, perfectly designed for "scooping" out large chunks of meat from a living creature.

Abykos: While on the trail, if one or more of the PCs is carrying any numenera that is transdimensional in nature, a hungry abykos appears. The abykos, which eats transdimensional energy, will attempt to attack any PC that's carrying the transdimensional numenera.

THE TRANSMISSION

As the group follows the path through the swamp, the transmission amulet begins to

chirp, alerting them to an incoming message. Shortly, all members of the party hear the following transmission. The voice is a whisper, at some points almost too soft to hear.

Blas, we arrived at the workshop yesterday. I . . . I wasn't able to send this until now. We were attacked before we could get the. . . the griefsteel thought Kalke was [pauses, as if trying to remember]. . . Zeph, I think? Everyone's gone and I can't remember why I'm here. I'm sorry, Blas. I'm so sorry. I know we were supposed to do something important. . . I just. . . what was it?

The voice trails off, as if deep in thought, and the transmission ends.

The voice sounds vaguely familiar to most of the PCs, although they can't quite place it at first. For PCs from Zeph, it's a difficulty 3 Intellect task to remember that the voice is that of a woman from town named Yigit.

Likely, the PCs will begin to speculate that today is not the first time that the installation activated, as no one remembers Blas sending another group out to the workshop. It's also okay if they don't know what's happening yet; they'll learn more once they encounter the person behind the voice in the workshop.

It's also possible that one or more of the PCs have heard of **griefsteels**, and know that they are automatons mourning the loss of their companion (or in this case, companions).

GM TIP: Download the audio file here <http://mymcg.info/forgettingdoomsday> to play the transmission to your group or read the transmission text aloud.

ARGENTBRIER

The characters come upon a large silver hedge, nearly 8 feet (2.5 m) high, so thick it's impossible to see through. The thorn trees don't seem native to this type of landscape and further inspection shows that they are not trees at all—but rather an inorganic substance that seems to have been “grown” into an interwoven pattern of protection.

INSPECTING THE ARGENTBRIER

Upon successful inspection, the PCs can discover the following:

- The argentbrier seems to be grown in a large circle surrounding the location where the workshop is supposed to be.
- Near where the trail ends, there are two small branches of the hedge that are slightly darker than the others. These branches, which are covered in the same spines as the rest of the hedge, can be moved to allow someone to look inside. They can see a large metal disc, about 20 feet (6 m) across and rising half a foot or so up from the ground.
- There doesn't appear to be anything moving inside.
- Nearby is another section of the hedge that seems like it could be coaxed into a different position (a difficulty 6 Intellect action) that would allow someone to slip through.

If a cypher is within immediate distance of the hedge, it snakes out tiny silver tendrils toward the devices. If the tendrils touch the cypher, they detach from the main hedge and attempt to root into the cypher, disappearing completely. Anyone carrying cyphers and moving close to or through the argentbrier has to make a level 2 Speed defense roll to avoid losing one of their cyphers to the tendrils.

THE WORKSHOP

Once inside the argentbrier, the PCs hear a yell—possibly the same voice that they heard on the transmission. It seems to be coming from somewhere *above* the disk, although there is nothing to be seen up there.

A series of twenty large translucent squares line the top of the disc. Putting pressure on a square causes it to light up, but only as

long as the pressure remains. It's a difficulty 5 Intellect task to determine that seven of the twenty of the squares are placed in such a way that they resemble the brand used by the brothers (the same one the PCs saw on the installation in the valley). Putting at least a few pounds of weight on each of these squares at the same time causes them to light up all at once, and the disk will begin to rise.

Once the disk is about 10 feet (3 m) off the ground, the PCs find themselves inside a large, round structure. The disk “clicks” into place and becomes part of the floor. The entirety of the round building seems to be this single room. The round walls and ceiling are transparent, allowing a view over the top of the argentbrier and up into the sky. It's filled with workbenches, half-finished installations and objects, bookshelves, and writing boards.

Also in the room is a large automaton—a griefsteel. It's facing away from the PCs when they arrive, but at the first bit of noise from the group, it will turn toward them. As it does so, they can see a woman behind it. She's slumped on a high workbench, clearly distraught, her left arm bandaged.

Griefsteel: Depending on how the PCs react, it might attack them, ignore them, or attach to one of them (mistaking them for its former companion). It is carrying a component that looks like the one the PCs are searching for, similar to the way a child might carry a beloved toy from a parent.

Argentbrier: level 7

Argentbrier tendrils: level 2; if a tendril attaches to a cypher and is allowed to root in completely, it destroys the cypher, rendering it useless.

GM intrusion

suggestion: As the PCs are inspecting the argentbrier, a flock of tiny silver birds suddenly flies out of the hedge. They circle overhead cawing a raucous warning cry and dropping tiny metal ovals on the PCs.

Silver birds (as a flock): level 3, defense as level 5 due to speed and size; drop metal ovals that do 2 points of damage



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GRIEFSTEEL

7 (21)

Whether encountered in the deeps of a lonely ruin or wandering across the empty landscape, the sorrow-wracked griefsteel is an automaton that is unlikely to ever find solace. Crafted to serve as a companion to someone who died aeons before, these shambling mechs are forever heartbroken. Though they are self-aware automatons that are able to learn, some still get stuck in a mental loop from which they're unable to escape.

Unending sorrow makes them unpredictable. They're not usually a threat, but they're also not usually helpful. They're too lost in their own misery to notice or care about others' needs. Sometimes, an anguished automaton strikes out in fury over their loss, and explorers who've disrupted their iterative depressive cycle make good targets—especially those who remind griefsteels of what they've lost.

Motive: To be left alone

Environment: Anywhere

Health: 25

Damage Inflicted: 8 points

Armor: 3

Movement: Short (some individuals can fly a long distance each round)

Modifications: Ability to detect falsehood or pierce disguise as level 4, because they want to believe

Combat: A griefsteel can be one of many different kinds of automaton, which means that different ones will bring different abilities in combat, though most prefer not to enter combat unless they are provoked (and some, not even then). At minimum, a griefsteel can batter three or more foes within immediate range with their metallic limbs. Many can also emit an energy ray that inflicts damage on up to three targets within long range. If direct mental or machine communication is attempted, or any other sort of interaction, the creature attempting the interaction experiences the trauma of the griefsteel's loss directly. Unless they can resist, they are stunned and lose their next turn.

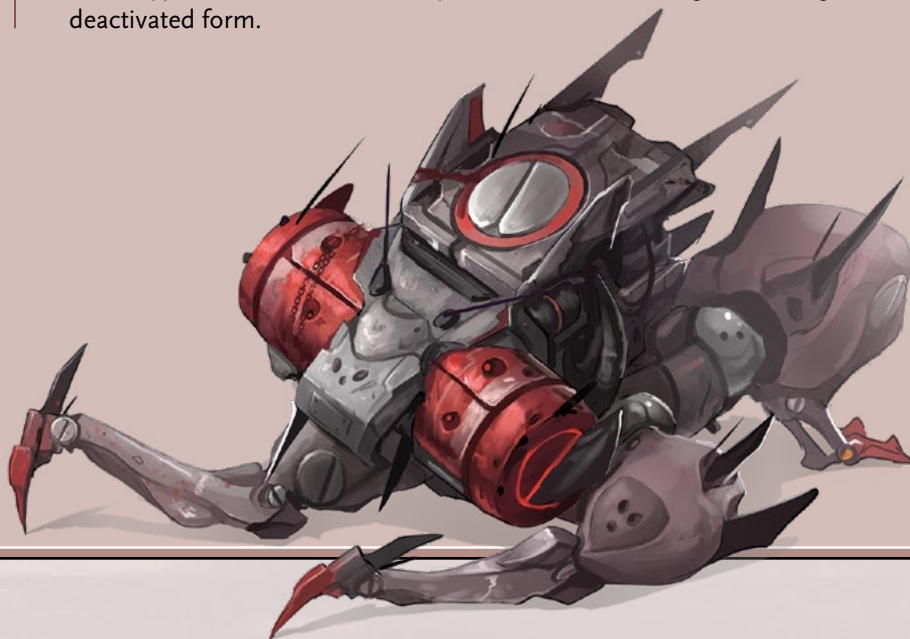
Interaction: Griefsteels might first ignore, then wail at someone trying to communicate with them. If communication attempts persist, they will finally strike out at whoever is bothering them, unless the intruder is extremely persuasive and calming.

Use: The characters who've learned that plans (or components) they want might be found within a crashed vehicle or ruin are stymied by a griefsteel that is using the place as a base of sorts. It must be mollified or deactivated before the PCs can gather what they need.

Loot: 1d6 cyphers and 1 or 2 units of psiranium can be salvaged from a griefsteel's deactivated form.

Sometimes a griefsteel mistakes a traveler for the one who originally built them.

GM intrusion: The griefsteel mistakenly believes that the character is their long-lost companion, but it begins to have doubts, which makes it very angry.



Yigit: The PCs from Zeph will recognize Yigit as someone who works with them. It is likely disturbing to them that they completely forgot about her.

She is dehydrated, scared, injured, and confused, all of which makes it hard to interact with her. At first, she reacts in a paranoid fashion to the PCs, threatening to hurt them if they come too close. If the PCs convince her to trust them and let them heal, feed, or otherwise improve her physical state, she calms down. She's able to remember that something happened, and that Blas sent her here with some other people, but she doesn't remember where they are or what she was sent here to do. She might also recognize one of the PCs.

If she comes to truly trust at least one of the PCs, she mentions a device that she thinks Blas gave her, although she doesn't remember what it does. She pulls a small blue square out of her pocket. Studying the cypher shows it to be a teleportation box. Blas set it to teleport Yigit and her group back to the installation.

The Workshop: Searching the workshop reveals that a great deal has already been scavenged, badly broken, or destroyed by creatures. If the PCs spend an hour scavenging, they can find 20 shins, a destiny nodule cypher, an instant workshop cypher, an installation plan for an *auto mender*, and two rolls on the *lotum Result Table*.

Time Check: At this point, you're about three-quarters of the way through the adventure. You should have at least an hour left if you're running a four-hour game.

THE REPLACEMENT COMPONENT

At this point, the PCs have a number of options. They can attempt to take the component away from the griefsteel, they can salvage the necessary parts and then repair the broken component, or they can scrounge up the necessary parts and craft a new component.

Repair: Finding the necessary parts for repair is a difficulty 4 salvaging numenera task that

takes about ten minutes. Using the parts to repair the component is a difficulty 6 crafting numenera task that takes about an hour.

Craft: Finding the necessary parts to build a new component is a difficulty 6 salvaging task that takes about an hour. Using the parts to build a new component is a difficulty 4 crafting numenera task that takes about ten minutes.

DESTINY NODULE

Level: 3

Usable: Crystal nodule affixed to tool

Effect: For the next 28 hours, each time the tool the nodule is attached to is used to repair, craft, or modify an object or structure, the tool provides the user an additional asset to the task.

INSTANT WORKSHOP

Level: 5

Usable: Handheld device

Effect: This small device expands into a workbench that fixes itself in place. The workbench provides an adjustable-height work surface with light and a variety of attached tools suitable for working with commonplace objects, numenera objects, and structural components. The workshop enables crafting tasks by providing the appropriate tools and workspace, though it does not provide shelter from the elements. The workbench and all its components are made from a form of shapemetal, and the workbench is permanent and immobile once created.

TELEPORTATION BOX

Level: 9

Usable: Small blue box

Effect: Must be activated twice. First at the future arrival point, then again when it's ready to be used. Anyone touching the box when it is activated is teleported instantly to the arrival point where the box was originally activated.

Yigit: level 4, memory tasks are hindered by 2 steps due to virus



*Automender
(installation plan),
page 154*

*lotum Result Table,
page 110*

RETURNING HOME

The PCs can return to the valley by walking or by using the teleportation box. They can also use the transmission amulet to record a message for Blas and Liliya, which will automatically be sent to them when the amulet is within range.

Once they arrive, they find Blas and Liliya both still near the installation. Being so close to the installation for so long has caused their memories to fade much faster than normal. Neither of them recognize the PCs.

They seem to be completely focused on protecting the installation, almost to the point of mania. They will attempt to prevent anyone from touching it, including the PCs. In order to install the component, the PCs must persuade their leaders to remember or trust them, subdue them in some way, or attempt some other action to gain access to the installation.

Once the PCs have access, replacing the component is a difficulty 3 task and only takes a few minutes. The effect is almost instantaneous—the PCs not only feel their

own memories returning, they can see and hear that the same is true for Yigit, Liliya, and Blas. All of them now remember the first time the installation activated and the initial group that was sent out to the workshop. Yigit vows to go and find the other members of her group.

In addition, the installation is now working properly to protect the valley from negative mental effects in the future.

Will the villages come back together to fulfill the dream of the original founders? Will some of the PCs go with Yigit on her quest to find her lost companions? Will one of the PCs craft an automender installation that everyone can freely use to heal themselves and their loved ones? Only time will tell.

XP Awards: If the PCs successfully repair the installation and contain the virus, they each gain 4 XP. If they were able to save Yigit, they each gain 1 XP. These awards are in addition to any XP earned from GM intrusions and discoveries.



SPECIAL ABILITIES

Trained in Armor: You reduce the Speed Effort cost for wearing armor by 1

Health: Add 1 to the points you regain when you make a recovery roll.

Attack Flourish. With your attack, you add stylish moves, entertaining quips, or a certain "something" that entertains or impresses others. One creature you choose within short range who can see you gains an asset to its next task.

Fleet of Foot (1+ Speed points): You can move a short distance as part of another action. You can move a long distance as your entire action for a turn. If you apply a level of Effort to this ability, you can move a long distance and make an attack as your entire action for a turn, but the attack is hindered. Enabler.

Impressive Display (2 Might points): You perform a feat of strength, speed, or combat, impressing those nearby. For the next minute you gain an asset in all interaction tasks with people who saw you use this ability. Action.

SKILLS / INABILITIES

- Climbing (trained)
- Might defense (trained)
- Crafting numenera (inability)
- Salvaging numenera (inability)
- Understanding numenera (inability)

NUMENERA

ALHERI IS A

TOUGH GLAIVE

WHO FIGHTS WITH PANACHE

5 SHINS

EQUIPMENT

- Extremely stylish clothing
- Jeweled greataxe (heavy)
- Bow and 12 arrows (medium)
- Razor ring (light)

Oddity: Comb that glows when used

ATTACKS

- You can use any weapon without penalty.
- Combat Prowess: +1 damage to melee attacks
- Jeweled greataxe (6 points of damage)
- Bow and arrows (4 points of damage)
- Razor ring (2 points of damage; eases attack)

2 LIMIT

CYPHERS

15 POOL

1 EDGE

11 POOL

1 EDGE

8 POOL

0 EDGE

MIGHT

SPEED

INTELLECT

1 ARMOR COST

from Resilient

DEBILITATED

IMPAIRED

1 TIER

1 EFFORT

XP

RECOVERY

1 ACTION

10 MINS

1 HOUR

10 HOURS

1D6+

Destiny Nodule (level 4)
Crystal nodule affixed to tool. For the next 28 hours, each time the tool the nodule is attached to is used to repair, craft, or modify an object or structure, the tool provides the user an additional asset to the task.

Rejuvenator (level 5)
Pill that restores 5 points to user's Might Pool

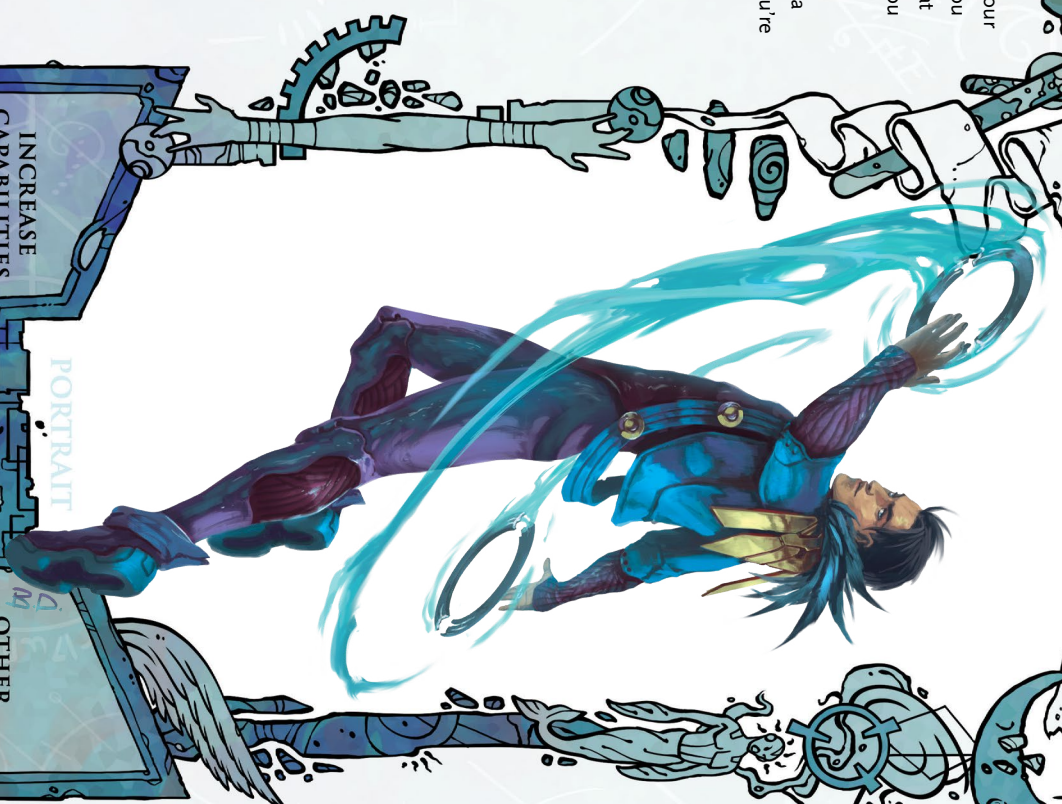
BACKGROUND

You grew up in the town of Ovon, and have spent your life training to protect your home with everything you have. You have no desire to ever leave this place that you love, but Lilja is your mentor and guide, and you will stand by her side no matter what.

You are always trying to impress Yarnu with your skill, wit, appearance, or bravado. Perhaps they are a rival, perhaps you need their respect, or perhaps you're romantically interested in them.

ALHERI

NOTES



PORTRAIT

INCREASE
CAPABILITIES

◆ +4 TO
STAT POOLS

ADVANCEMENT

◆ REFER TO
NUMENERA DISCOVERY

OTHER

◆ +1 TO EFFORT
EXTRA
EFFORT

◆ SKILL
TRAINING
TRAIN OR
SPECIALIZE
IN A SKILL

MOVE TOWARD
PERFECTION

◆ +1 TO EDGE

SPECIAL ABILITIES

Flex Skill: At the beginning of each day, choose one task (other than attacks or defense) on which you will concentrate. For the rest of that day, you're trained in that task. You can't use this ability with a skill you're already trained in to become specialized.

Critter Companion: A drakka* accompanies you and follows your instructions, acting on your turn. As a level 1 creature, it has a target number of 3 and a health of 3, and it inflicts 1 point of damage. Enabler.

Link Senses (2 Intellect points): You touch a willing creature and link its senses to yours for one minute. At any time during that duration, you can concentrate to see, hear, and smell what that creature is experiencing, instead of using your own senses. If you or the creature move out of long range, the connection is broken. Action to initiate.

Phase Sprint (1+ Speed point): You can run up to a long distance so long as you take no other actions. During your action and until the beginning of your next turn, you are partially phased, and some attacks pass through you harmlessly. While phased, you gain an asset to your Speed defense tasks, but you lose any benefit from armor you wear. Action.

Disrupting Touch (1+ Might points): You can turn your Phase Sprint into a melee attack by grazing another creature as you run. When you do, the touch releases a violent blast of energy that inflicts 2 points of damage to the target (ignores Armor). Whether you hit or miss, your movement (and turn) ends immediately, which puts you within immediate distance of your target. If you apply Effort to increase damage rather than to ease the task, you deal 2 additional points of damage per level of Effort (instead of 3 points); however, the target takes 1 point of damage even if you fail the attack roll. Enabler.

Shapemetal (level 6)
Canister containing a silvery, shapeable clay. This metallic clay can be shaped and greatly expanded to create individual tools or objects such as a hammer, a ladder, or a basic structure such as a wall, bench, floor, staircase, and so on, as long as the total volume created could fit in a 10-foot (3 m) cube. Once formed, the structure or objects are permanent.

Shocker (level 6)
Ring that delivers a powerful burst of electricity that shocks any creature touched, inflicting 6 points of damage.

NUMENÉRA

YAMU

IS A

CLEVER JACK

WHO SHREDS THE WALLS OF THE WORLD

POOL 12

EDGE 0

POOL 14

EDGE 1

POOL 12

EDGE 0

MIGHT

SPEED

INTELLECT

ARMOR 1

COST

DEBILITATED

IMPAIRED

RECOVERY 10 HOURS

1 HOUR

10 MINS

1 ACTION

1D6+

TIER 1

EFFORT 1

XP

SKILLS / INABILITIES

Perception (trained)

All interactions involving lies or trickery (trained)

Defense rolls to resist mental effects (trained)

Tasks involving identifying or assessing danger, lies, quality, importance, function, or power (trained)

Any task involving lore, knowledge, or understanding (inability)

EQUIPMENT

10 SHINS

Explorer's pack

Pack of light tools

Clothing

Leather armor (light)

Dagger (light)

Hammer (medium)

Oddity: Brass device with nested circular plates that rotate and click

ATTACKS

You can use light and medium weapons without penalty.

You have an inability with heavy weapons; your attacks with heavy weapons are hindered.

Dagger (2 points of damage; eases attack)

Hammer (4 points of damage)

BACKGROUND

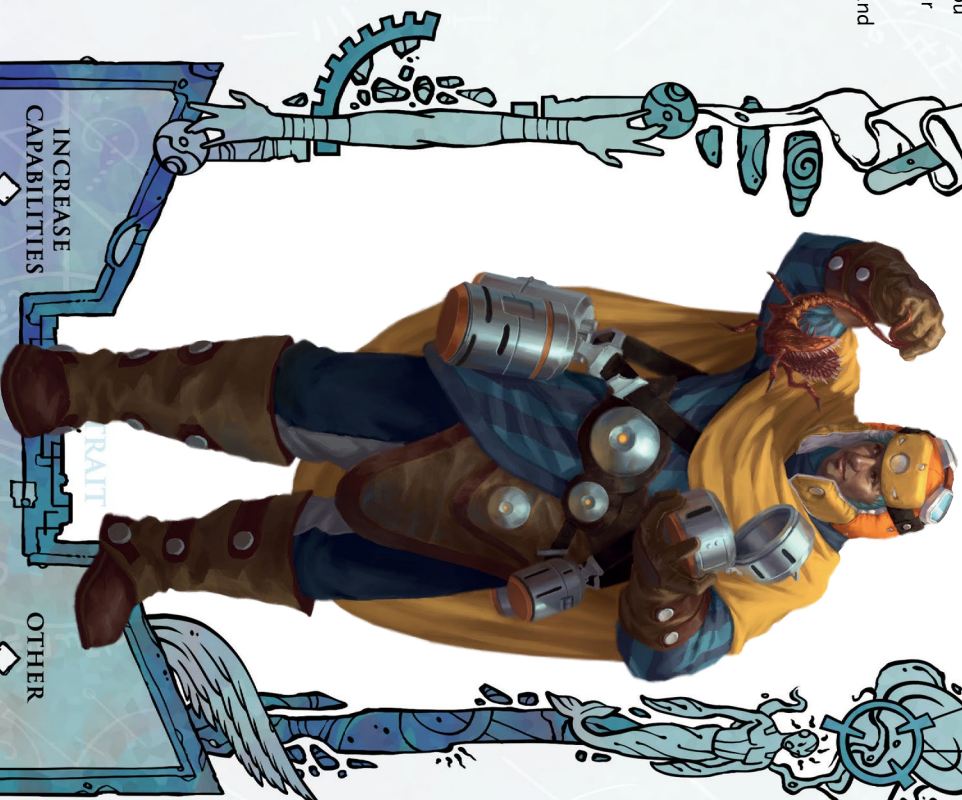
You grew up in the town of Ovon, but unlike many others, you don't have any particular kinship to it. You feel like you were destined for something greater—or at least a little farther away. Still, you like the people here well enough. If you have the chance to just go and explore, you know you'd come back eventually.

For some reason, Ktor never loses sense of where you are, no matter how you sprint around, change phase, or even become invisible (to everyone else).

YAMU

NOTES

*Drakka are insects similar to bluebottle flies, but much larger (up to a foot in length) and more intelligent. People use drakka for tasks like herding animals or alerting them to signs of trouble spied from on high.



INCREASE
CAPABILITIES

◆ +4 TO
STAT POOLS

ADVANCEMENT

◆ REFER TO
NUMMENERA DISCOVERY

OTHER

◆

◆ +1 TO EFFORT
EXTRA
EFFORT

◆ SKILL
TRAINING
SPECIALIZE
IN A SKILL

MOVE TOWARD
PERFECTION

◆ +1 TO EDGE

SPECIAL ABILITIES

Community Activist. You are trained in persuasion and intimidation tasks when speaking to others in the community you foster about topics that directly relate to the community. Enabler.

Demeanor of Command (2 Intellect points): You exude confidence, knowledge, and charisma to all who see you for the next hour. When you speak, strangers that are not already attacking give you at least a round to have your say. If speaking to a group that can understand you, you can attempt to have them produce their leader or ask that they take you to their leader. You gain a free level of Effort that can be applied to one persuasion task you attempt during this period. Action to initiate.

Understanding (1 Intellect point): You observe or study a creature or object. Your next interaction with that creature or object gains one asset. Action.

Trained Without Armor: You are trained in Speed defense actions when not wearing armor. Enabler.

Community Knowledge (2 Intellect points). If you've invested yourself in a community and have spent at least a few months living there, you can learn things about it through a variety of methods. Sometimes contacts slip the information to you. Other times, you're able to draw conclusions simply by what you can see and hear.

When you use this ability, you can ask the GM one question about the community and get a very short answer. Action.

CYPHERS

Intellect Enhancement (level 3)
Pill that adds 1 to Intellect Edge for one hour

Sleep Inducer (level 6)
Fingertip cusp. Touch puts the victim to sleep for ten minutes or until awoken by a violent action or an extremely loud noise.

SKILLS / INABILITIES

- Persuasion (trained)
- Speed defense (without armor) (trained)
- Geography (trained)
- Remembering/memorizing things you experience directly (trained)

KTOR IS A

INTELLIGENT ARKUS

WHO SHEPHERDS THE COMMUNITY

EQUIPMENT

- Stylish clothing
- Dart thrower and 12 darts (light weapon)
- Oddity: Lightning bug in a glass globe

ARMOR

COST

8 POOL

0 EDGE

11 POOL

0 EDGE

17 POOL

1 EDGE

MIGHT

SPEED

INTELLECT

1 TIER

1 EFFORT

XP

RECOVERY

1 ACTION

10 MINS

1 HOUR

10 HOURS

1D6+

ATTACKS

You can use light weapons without penalty. You have an **inability** with medium and heavy weapons; your attacks with medium and heavy weapons are hindered.

Dart thrower (2 points of damage, eases attack)

BACKGROUND

Lilja is like a mother to you, and you've learned so much from her as a leader. You hope someday you might become a leader, too, whether in Ovon or somewhere else.

For some reason, you never lose sense of where Yamu is, no matter how they sprint around, change phase, or even become invisible (to everyone else).

Even though Sidri is from a community that's a rival of the community you protect, you hope that maybe through them you can build a bridge.

KTOR

NOTES

CRAFTING

FOLLOWERS

INCREASE
CAPABILITIES
◆
+4 TO
STAT POOLS

ADVANCEMENT

OTHER
◆
REFER TO
COREBOOK

+1 TO EFFORT
◆
EXTRA
EFFORT

SKILL
TRAINING
◆
TRAIN OR
SPECIALIZE
IN A SKILL

MOVE TOWARD
PERFECTION
◆
+1 TO EDGE

UNITS
MATERIALS

PARTS

UNITS

BACKGROUND

You've not thought much about the world beyond Zephi. Who needs to? You have your family here, your friends, and a job you love. What more could anyone ask for? You and Blas don't always see eye-to-eye, but he's a good leader and you're proud to be on his team. You and Ristam have known each other since you were kids. They still bear a scar from one of your more...unwise...childhood adventures together. Despite that, you have a close friendship to this day.

SIDRI

NOTES

move and lift heavy objects, either stacking them in precise piles or unstacking them, as required. Lifting adventures move too slowly to lift creatures that have the ability to move away from its lifter arms. A lifting adventure can be commanded to stack only certain kinds of objects, to stack different kinds of objects using alternate methods and in different locations, and so on.

Depletion: 1 in 1d20 (check per year of use)

CRAFTING

7 units of io
7 units of responsive synth
1 unit of apt clay
3 units of pliable metal
9 units of parts

PLANS

Alarm Mech

Minimum Crafting Level: 1

Return: 1o (1 units); responsive synth (4 units); apt clay (1 unit); pliable metal (3 units); parts (8 units)

This plan produces a disc-shaped limited automaton about half a foot (15 cm) in diameter. The mech moves on a dozen metallic legs. When released and set to guard, the mech patrols an area a short distance across (or less, if set within a smaller room or structure). It provides an asset to all tasks related to perception, noticing intruders, and initiative in the patrolled area for those who set the automaton.

Depletion: 1 in 1d20 (check per week of use)

Lifting Adventon

Minimum Crafting Level: 3

Return: 1o (1d6 units); responsive synth (12 units); apt clay (3 units); pliable metal (4 units); parts (31 units)
This plan produces a blocky, limited automaton about 3 feet (1 m) on a side with a pair of extendable lift arms. The automaton moves on a dozen metallic legs up to a short distance each round. If commanded, the automaton can

PARTS

Continued under notes

PORTRAIT

INCREASE CAPABILITIES

+4 TO STAT POOLS

ADVANCEMENT

OTHER
REFER TO COREBOOK

EXTRA EFFORT

SKILL TRAINING
TRAIN OR SPECIALIZE IN A SKILL

MOVE TOWARD PERFECTION

+1 TO EDGE

FOLLOWERS

SPECIAL ABILITIES

Familiarize: You can familiarize yourself with a new area if you spend at least one hour studying a region up to a long distance across that you are able to directly access and move about in. Once you've familiarized yourself with an area, all your tasks related to perception, navigation, salvaging, defense, and moving about the area gain an asset. Each time you familiarize yourself with a new area, you lose focus on a previous area unless you expend 1 XP to retain the familiarity permanently. Action to initiate, one hour to complete.

Imaginative Solution: When you apply a level of Effort to any Intellect task, you gain a free level of Effort. You can do this one time, although the ability is renewed each time you make a ten-hour recovery roll.

Ribbons of Dark Matter (2 Intellect points): For the next minute, dark matter condenses within an area within long range that is no bigger than an immediate distance in diameter, manifesting as swirling ribbons. All tasks attempted by creatures in the area are hindered, and leaving the area requires the creature's entire action to move. You can dismiss the dark matter early as an action. Action to initiate.

CYPHERS

2

LIMIT

Psychic Communique (level 5)
Metallic disk that allows the user to project a one-time, one-way telepathic message of up to ten words per cypher level, with an unlimited range, to anyone they know.

Sonic Hole (level 3)
Wristband that draws all sound within long range into the device for one round per cypher level. Within the affected area, no sound can be heard.

NUMENÉRA

IS A

RISTAM

IMAGINATIVE DELVE

DANCES WITH DARK MATTER

WHO

9

POOL

0

EDGE

12

POOL

1

EDGE

15

POOL

1

EDGE

MIGHT

SPEED

INTELLECT

ARMOR

0

COST

DEBILITATED

IMPAIRED

1

TIER

1

EFFORT

XP

1 ACTION

10 MINS

1 HOUR

10 HOURS

RECOVERY

3

SHINS

EQUIPMENT

Clothing

Polearm (medium weapon)

Pack of light tools

Explorer's pack

Oddity: Fuzzy stuffed ravage bear that makes growling noises when you squeeze it

ATTACKS

Weapons: You can use light and medium weapons without penalty. You have an **inability** with heavy weapons; your attacks with heavy weapons are hindered.

Polearm (4 points of damage)

SKILLS / INABILITIES

(trained)

Salvaging numenera

(trained)

Sensing danger

(trained)

Initiative

(trained)

Tracking

(trained)

Singing

BACKGROUND

Zeph hasn't been the same for you since your partner passed away last year. Wherever you go there are lingering memories, the taste of bittersweet loss. Thank goodness for Fision, who helped you through much of your grieving.

You've known Sidri since you were a child. You still bear a scar from one of your more...unwise...childhood adventures together.

RISTAM

NOTES

CRAFTING

1 unit of responsive synth

FOLLOWERS



PORTRAIT

INCREASE
CAPABILITIES

◆
+4 TO
STAT POOLS

ADVANCEMENT

◆
+1 TO EFFORT
EXTRA
EFFORT

◆
SKILL
TRAINING
TRAIN OR
SPECIALIZE
IN A SKILL

◆
OTHER
REFER TO
COREBOOK

MOVE TOWARD
PERFECTION

◆
+1 TO EDGE

UNITS
MATERIALS

PARTS

UNITS

SPECIAL ABILITIES

Onslaught (1 Intellect point): You attack a foe using energies that assail either their physical form or their mind. In either case, you must be able to see your target. If the attack is physical, you emit a short-range ray of force that inflicts 4 points of damage. If the attack is mental, you focus your mental energy to blast the thought processes of another creature within short range. This mindslice inflicts 2 points of Intellect damage (and thus ignores Armor). Some creatures without minds (such as automatons) might be immune to your mindslice. Action.

Ward: You have a shield of energy around you at all times that helps deflect attacks. You gain +1 to Armor. Enabler.

Good Advice. Anyone can help an ally, easing whatever task they're attempting. However, you have the benefit of clarity and wisdom. When you help another character, they gain an additional asset. Enabler.

SKILLS / INABILITIES

- Social interactions (trained)
- Persuasion (trained)
- History (trained)
- Defense rolls to resist disease and poison (trained)
- Consolation and emotional support to others (trained)
- Understanding numerera (trained)
- Detecting a lie (inability)

NUMENÉRA

IS A

FISION

EARNEST NANO

WHO

LEADS

8 POOL

0 EDGE

10 POOL

0 EDGE

18 POOL

1 EDGE

MIGHT

SPEED

INTELLECT

1 ARMOR due to Ward

4 SHINS

EQUIPMENT

1 TIER

1 EFFORT

1 XP

RECOVERY

1 ACTION 10 MINS

1 HOUR

10 HOURS

DEBILITATED

IMPAIRED

CYPHERS

3 LIMIT

Deception Filter (level 1)
A pill that makes it so the user cannot knowingly tell a lie for one hour.

Heat Nodule (level 2)
Crystal nodule affixed to a melee weapon. For the next 28 hours, each time the weapon the nodule is attached to strikes a solid creature or object, it generates a burst of heat, inflicting an additional 2 points of damage.

Sheen (level 3)
Pill. For one week, the user's cells are coated with a protective veneer that resists damage (+1 to Armor) and eases Might defense rolls by two steps. However, healing is more difficult during this time; all recovery rolls suffer a -1 penalty.

Oddity: Scarf that appears to be made of silk but is virtually indestructible and cannot be dirtied or stained

ATTACKS

You can use light weapons without penalty. You have an **inability** with medium and heavy weapons; your attacks with medium and heavy weapons are hindered.

Whip (2 points of damage; eases attack)

BACKGROUND

Lately, Blas has been asking you about your future—you sense that he considers you someone who might replace him someday. While you have every desire to lead, and believe you will be good at it, you're not ready to think about the day when Blas can no longer be at the helm of Zeph.

You and Ristam became close recently, when you offered support after the loss of their partner.

The first time you meet Alheri, you feel a special bond with them, although you have no idea why. Possibly you are related to them, share similar passions, or just think you have the potential to become great friends.

FISION

NOTES



INCREASE
CAPABILITIES

◆
+4 TO
STAT POOLS

ADVANCEMENT

◆
REFER TO
NUMENERA DISCOVERY

OTHER

◆

+1 TO EFFORT
◆
EXTRA
EFFORT

SKILL
TRAINING
◆
TRAIN OR
SPECIALIZE
IN A SKILL

MOVE TOWARD
PERFECTION

◆

+1 TO EDGE